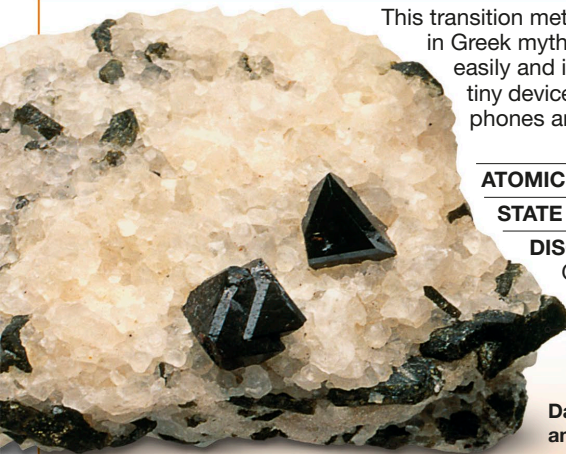


Tantalum

73
Ta



This transition metal gets its name from Tantalus, a figure in Greek mythology. Tantalum does not corrode easily and is used to make capacitors, which are tiny devices for storing electricity inside mobile phones and tablets.

ATOMIC MASS 180.948

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1802 (Anders Gustav Ekeberg)

Microlite is so named because it forms tiny crystals.

Dark crystals of microlite, an ore of tantalum, in rock

Tungsten

74
W

This element has the highest melting point of any metal: it melts into a liquid at a scorching 3,414°C (6,177.2°F). Due to its heat-resistant properties, tungsten is used to make light bulb filaments, which can get very hot when a bulb is in use. This element is also mixed with carbon to make tungsten carbide, a compound used to harden metal tools.

ATOMIC MASS 183.84

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1783 (Juan and Fausto Elhuyar)

Ferberite, an ore of tungsten

